MONDAY
OCTOBER 12, 2026
JUMADA AL ULA 1, 1448

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LIVE UPDATES

UAE, WORLD STRONGLY CONDEMN HOUTHI ATTACKS ON RIYADH AIRPORT

12 dead, 309 injured, as Trump weighs US action

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE and world leaders yesterday strongly condemned the deadly Houthi attack on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport, as US President Donald Trump weighed military intervention.

Saturday's attack, which killed 12 people and injured 309, was the deadliest on Saudi soil in more than a decade, marking a sharp escalation in the Yemen conflict.

Yesterday, a fresh fire broke out at the airport after an unidentified projectile struck Terminal 4. Saudi authorities also reported intercepting and destroying a cruise missile near the airport.

The Saudi-led coalition blamed the Iran-backed Houthis for the attack, describing it as a "full-fledged war crime".

The dead included four Saudis, two Bangladeshis and one national each from the US, Egypt, Jordan, Syria, Palestine and Sudan. Some of the injured remained in serious condition.

Airport operations remained suspended yesterday, with AFP quoting an aviation source as saying the closure would remain in place "until further notice".

UAE reaffirms full solidarity

The UAE condemned the attacks as a flagrant violation of Saudi sovereignty and reaffirmed full solidarity with the kingdom and support for measures to safeguard its security and stability.

Trump said Washington was considering joining Saudi-led strikes against the Houthis.



AP

■ Thick black smoke and flames rise from a fire at King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh after a Houthi attack.

"We may. We're going to look at it," he said, adding that a decision could come quickly.

He also planned to speak with Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed Bin Salman.

Pakistan, Turkey support

Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif condemned the attack, invoking Islamabad's defence commitments under the Makkah Joint Defence Agreement. "Pakistan stands in unwavering solidarity with the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, its leadership and brotherly people," Sharif said. Turkey condemned Houthi attacks on Riyadh and Abha airports, reaffirming its solidarity with Saudi Arabia.

India also denounced the repeated attacks, saying assaults on civilians and civilian infrastructure were "completely unacceptable and must cease immediately".

UN demands halt to attacks

UN Secretary-General António Guterres condemned the strike, warning that attacks on civilians and civilian infrastructure violated international law.

European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen warned that Iran-backed groups were pushing the region into a spiral of violence and threatening global transport and energy infrastructure. EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas called the strike an "appalling act of terror".

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio confirmed an American was among those killed and demanded an immediate halt to attacks.

Britain, France, Germany, Russia and Canada also condemned the strike. France pledged continued support for Saudi Arabia's defence, while Russia urged diplomacy. The Arab League, Syria, Iraq and Lebanon expressed solidarity with Riyadh.

Meanwhile, the Houthis renewed threats against Saudi airports, raising fears of further attacks and wider regional escalation.

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Mohammed: Trust is the currency of the future

Trust matters more than AI, energy, water or even data, he says in letter

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, has shared the latest of his letters from his new book, arguing that the most important currency for the future is not water, artificial intelligence, energy or data, but trust.

In 'A Letter on the Currency of the Future', Sheikh Mohammed recounts a discussion with friends and officials about what the world's most valuable resource will be in the years ahead.

Some argued for water, pointing to growing scarcity and conflict over supplies. Others chose artificial intelligence, which is reshaping economies and everyday life. A third group said energy, without which AI and much of the technology of the future cannot operate.

Sheikh Mohammed's answer was different. "The currency we are betting on is trust," he wrote.

He argued that people's trust in the UAE is what attracts investors and talent, builds international partnerships and gives the country access to technology, capital and expertise.

Trust, he wrote, is increasingly scarce, and that scarcity makes it more valuable.

The letter is part of *The Letters*, the second part of Sheikh Mohammed's *Lessons from Life*.

Declining confidence

Sheikh Mohammed also pointed to declining confidence in governments around the world. The 2026 Edelman Trust Barometer found trust in government at 53 per cent across the 28 markets it surveyed. The UAE, together with China, ranked first on Edelman's broader Trust Index, which measures confidence across government, business, media and non-governmental organisations.

He also cited an OECD survey of 30 countries in which 39 per cent of respondents reported high or moderately high trust in their national government.

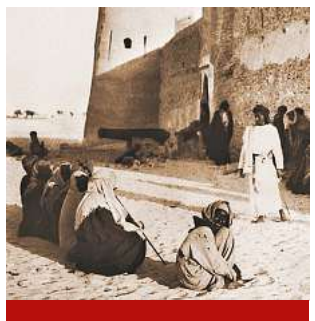
But the letter goes beyond rankings and statistics. Sheikh Mohammed argues that economic stability begins in people's minds: markets falter when investor confidence breaks, laws work when people trust that they apply equally, and societies respond more effectively to crises when citizens believe their government is acting in their interests.

He described trust as an asset built slowly through consistent laws, respect for people and a record of delivery, a reserve governments can draw on when crises arrive. "Trust is a covenant between us and the people," he wrote. "And we are a people who do not break our word."



IN FOCUS

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ABU DHABI

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Tech workers face long road to US residency

Labour Department freezes PERM filings at 8 firms, Indian workers in limbo

DUBAI

BY STACY PEREIRA
Business Reporter

The US Department of Labour has suspended eight technology and IT services companies from the Permanent Labour Certification Programme, known as PERM.

The companies are Microsoft, Adobe, Cognizant, Infosys, Tata, Wipro, HCL Technologies and Capgemini. The department said that it will accept no new PERM applications from the eight companies and would also halt processing of their pending cases while investigations continue. The suspension runs indefinitely.

PERM matters because it is the first step on the most common employer-sponsored green card route. An employer must show it found no qualified US worker for the role before it can file an immigrant petition.

Nasscom, India's IT industry body, calls the suspension temporary and limited to one immigration pathway.

But it is the tech employees who will have to carry the burden. Workers who have not started PERM may face an immediate stall, because their employer cannot file a new application. Staff with pending cases face delays, and the administration has yet to explain how it will treat them.

Indians account for a large share of H-1B beneficiaries and already face long backlogs in employment-based green card categories. A freeze at a sponsoring employer adds uncertainty to a wait that already spans years.

Things to consider

Candidates weighing offers from any of the eight companies should ask about green card sponsorship before signing, besides requesting written answers on when the company would file PERM and what happens to your case if the suspension continues.

Tech employees will have to confirm with their HRs whether their employer has filed for PERM or has a pending case, or has already secured certification. Ask the company's immigration counsel how the suspension affects your priority date. Keep copies of every filing, receipt and approval notice.

Dubai RTA wins Dubai-it award for speed and efficiency

Roads, bridges, tunnels delivered at twice the speed and efficiency of global benchmarks

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Dubai Executive Council Chairman, has announced that Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) has won the Dubai-it Award in the government institutions category, recognising its ability to deliver major infrastructure projects at twice the speed and efficiency of global benchmarks without compromising quality.

Sheikh Hamdan stated, "We announced the Dubai-it Award to celebrate Dubai's philosophy of work, brought to life by His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai. Dubai-it means achieving something extraordinary with excellence in record time."

Sheikh Hamdan added, "Today, RTA receives the award for Institutions in the Field of Government. It delivers major roads, bridges and tunnels at 2x global benchmarks for speed and efficiency without compromising quality. Metro punctuality stands at 99.7 per cent as the network continues to expand with more stations. Autonomous mobility and high-quality cycling routes advance at pace. Anticipating the city's needs. Enabling Dubai's next phase of growth. This is how RTA does Dubai-it. Congratulations to the team."



■ Sheikh Hamdan praised RTA's achievements in developing Dubai's transport infrastructure.

RTA executed a series of road projects and over 250 traffic improvements that contributed to cutting travel times by up to 60 per cent. It developed and operated AI-powered autonomous taxis to support the future of mobility in Dubai, developed the Air Taxi Station in Dubai to add a new mode to the city's future mobility ecosystem, and expanded and improved cycle tracks with high quality and in record time.

Additionally, RTA implemented 117 quick-win improvements within two years and succeeded in providing 82 services without any waiting time, reflecting its focus on reducing completion times and responding faster to the needs of transport network users.

SEE ALSO P2